

Industry News

Mobile apps revenue to triple this year

Market research analyst Gartner estimates the mobile application industry to touch \$15 billion in revenues by 2011 end, which is nearly triple of its revenues in 2010. Majority of app sales will come through Apple and Android mobile operating systems, and the growing sales of tablet computers like iPad.

Gartner further predicts that by 2014 the app industry will reach \$58 billion in revenue. Consumers will download 17.7 billion applications this year—more than double the 8.2 billion in 2010.

"Many are wondering if the app frenzy we have been witnessing is just a fashion, and, like many others, it shall pass. We do not think so," said Stephanie Baghdassarian, research director at Gartner.

India set to become a global hub for electronics

The last one decade has been remarkable for the Indian electronics industry. According to a white paper released by Frost & Sullivan, "From 18 million mobile phones in 2003 to 172 million units in 2010, shipment of three million PCs in 2003 to over 8.2 million PCs in 2010 and a non-

Novatium appoints new CEO

Novatium, a provider of PC as a service, has appointed Anurag Agrawal as the new chief executive officer for India operations. In this role, Agrawal will be responsible for driving the overall growth of the company in India and consolidate its leadership position in PC-as-a-service space.

Prior to joining Novatium, Agrawal was working with Tata Sky for over five years and is credited for setting up its pan-India customer service infrastructure from scratch.

Soota quits MindTree

Ashok Soota, co-founder of MindTree, is quitting the firm for 'personal reasons.'

Soota, who co-founded the company in August 1999, has requested that he be relieved as an employee and also as executive chairman/member of the board by 31st March, 2011.

"It is something I have thought about for a few months and arrived at a well-considered conclusion. I will finalise and announce my plans for a new business

venture, shortly after my departure from MindTree," said Soota.

Soota is the single largest shareholder in the company with over 11 per cent stake.

Red Hat appoints new country GM

Strengthening its India operations, Open Source brand Red Hat has appointed Anuj Kumar as the new country general manager and Jagjit Singh Arora as director, enterprise sales. Kumar, a Red Hat veteran of more than ten years, will oversee the company's India operations from a strategic and sales perspective.

In his previous role as general manager, Red Hat Middle East and Africa, Kumar was responsible for expanding the business in that region, growing the company's regional partner network to 300 resellers. An Open Source enthusiast, Kumar has championed the Open Source movement across the Middle East and Africa by closely working with Open Source communities, evangelists and policy makers.

existent market in 2003 to a rapidly growing LCD TV market that witnessed sales of 3.5 million units in 2010, the growth has been tremendous in all the segments of electronics—giving the industry a key position on the global map."

The Indian electronics industry has been growing at a CAGR of over 25 per cent for the last five years. The major reasons that can be attributed to this growth are GDP growth rates in excess of 8 per cent, revival of the global economy following the 2000-01 dot-com bubble burst,

a rapidly expanding middle class with increasing disposable income, continual decline in prices of most electronic goods, presence, expansion and/or entry of all major electronic OEMs and suppliers into the country, steady increase in exports and exemption of customs duty on 217 products that come under the ITA-1 list.

The Indian electronics industry is estimated to be worth \$47.5 billion in 2010, growing at over 20 per cent from 2009. Looking forward, the domestic market growth, coupled with export opportunities, is anticipated to herald India as a global hub for electronics in the decade 2010-20 with the electronics industry's size surpassing \$350 billion by 2020. Chief segments contributing to this growth are expected to be wireless, consumer electronics, aerospace and defence, medical devices and

